Human Resource Management is a function of management concerned with hiring, motivating and maintaining people in an organisation. It focuses on people in an organisation.

In the words of E.F.L.Brech HRM as that part of management process which is primarily concerned with the human constituents of an organisation.

9.05 Features of Human Resource Management

The following are the characteristics of human resource management :

i. **Universally relevant :** Human Resource Management has universal relevance. The approach and style varies depending the nature of organisation structure and is applicable at all levels.

ii. **Goal oriented :** The accomplishment of organisational goals is made possible through best utilisation of human resource in an organisation.

iii. **A systematic approach :** Human resource management lays emphasis on a systematic approach in managing the tasks performed by human resource of an organisation. The two sets of functions performed are managerial and operative functions.

iv. **It is all pervasive :** Wherever there is existence of human resource the effective management of the available human resource is very important especially in functional areas.

v. **It is a continuous process :** As long as there is human resource in the running of an organisation, the activities relating to managing human resource exists.

vi. **It is a dynamic activity :** Human resource management is not the same as that of other factors of production, as they have feelings and emotions which are to be handled with care and diligence to maximise its utilisation.

vii. **It is an integrative tool :** The main idea behind managing the human resource is to motivate, participate and coordinate the available work force.

viii. **Focuses on development :** Human resource management focuses on the development of manpower through training and development programmes. Honing of skills through training increases the effective use of the resource procured.

ix. **Human resource management is both science as well as art :** As it relies on experiments and observations as well as effective handling of manpower it is both science and art.

x. **It is interdisciplinary :** Human resource management makes use of concepts of different disciplines like sociology, psychology, economics etc. making it interdisciplinary.

xi. **It is intangible :** Human resource management is a intangible function which can be measured only by results.

9.06 Significance of Human Resource Management

The strategic role of human resource management is the process of acquiring, training, appraising, and compensating employees, and attending to their labour relation, health, safety and fariness concerns.

There are various reasons why human resource management is important. They are as follows:

i. **To identify manpower needs :** Determination of manpower needs in an organisation is very important as it is a form of investment. The number of men required are to be identified accurately to optimise the cost.

ii. **To incorporate change :** Change is constant in any organisation and this change has to be introduced in such a way that the human resource management acts as an agent to make the change effective.

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